non-interference in the internal affairs and seeking cooperation of India's neighbours'.[69] The speech combined the Jana Sangh's 'India First' approach with Nehruvianism.

POST-NEHRU SEARCH FOR POWER

The Nehruvian framework secured India global attention and, in V.P. Dutt's words, ensured that 'a country with very little military muscle on the morrow of independence and with no economic clout either could still be a significant factor in the international arena'. [70] Notwithstanding right-wing criticism of Nehru's policies during his years in power most Indian intellectuals agreed even after his death that his vision reflected national consensus. A study conducted in the early 1960s of around 100 Indian intellectuals who worked on foreign policy showed that the majority (83 per cent) endorsed non-alignment as the basis of India's foreign policy.[71] After Nehru's death in 1964, his successors felt the need to assert Indian power though they insisted their actions did not deviate from the first prime minister's structural design.

Scholars such as Kennedy argue that Nehru's 'bold diplomacy reflected his belief that his country had a unique capacity to promote international cooperation, and that such sacrifices were therefore worth making'. This confidence in India's diplomatic prowess, was not shared by Nehru's successors, which to Kennedy explains why 'none of them have acted with as much ambition or achieved as much global renown as he did'. Kennedy acknowledges that Nehru's successors have not 'suffered such painful setbacks' as Nehru did because they pursued more modest and realistic foreign policy goals. [72]

In recent years, Narendra Modi reflects a passion resembling Nehru in his zealous focus on foreign policy. After winning the 2014 general elections in a landslide, Modi has expended a lot of time and political capital on travelling around the world, wooing world leaders and global